

CHRISM MASS

The Chrism Mass is one of the principal expressions of unity and service in the diocese. Surrounded by all the Priests who share in his ministry, the Bishop blesses the holy oils to be used in the diocese throughout the year. As the oils are blessed, we recall that we share in the anointing, healing, and ministry that flow from these oils as they are used in the sacraments of faith.

The oils signify the universal charisms of the Church for healing (Oil of the Sick), faith building (Oil of the Catechumens), and consecration (Chrism). In accord with traditional practice, the blessing of the Oil of the Sick takes place before the end of the Eucharistic Prayer, but the blessing of the Oil of Catechumens and the consecration of the Chrism take place after Communion. Nevertheless, for pastoral reasons, it is permitted for the entire rite of blessing to take place after the Liturgy of the Word.

The *Oil of the Sick* is used for the Sacrament of the Anointing of the Sick. The Priest lays hands on the sick or elderly person, says special prayers, and anoints the person by placing oil in the form of a cross on the forehead and hands.

The *Oil of Catechumens* is a protective oil, used to anoint both adults and infants before Baptism. The prayer at the anointing for adults is that God will instill them with the wisdom for discernment and the strength to avoid evil during their inquiry into the Catholic faith. For infants, the prayer is to help ward off evil, avoid temptation, and possess the faith necessary to carry the Cross of Christ throughout life.

Anointing with *Chrism* (the perfumed oil) signifies the gift of the Holy Spirit. It is used to consecrate someone or something to God's service. It is used in the Sacraments of Baptism, Confirmation, and Holy Orders. Chrism is the anointing oil used in the consecration of a church and the blessing of an altar.

All Catholics have been anointed in the common priesthood of believers. The ordained have been consecrated at their ordination to carry out the sacramental ministry of the Church. It is within this context that the Bishop, as the shepherd of the diocese, calls upon the clergy to renew their commitment to priestly service.



PARTICIPANT RELEASE

Please be aware that by entering this area, you consent to your voice, name, and/or likeness being used, without compensation, in films and tapes for use in any and all media associated with the Catholic Diocese of Savannah, and you release the Catholic Diocese of Savannah, its successors, assigns, and licensees from any liability whatsoever of any nature. Please speak with an usher or diocesan representative if you have any questions or concerns.